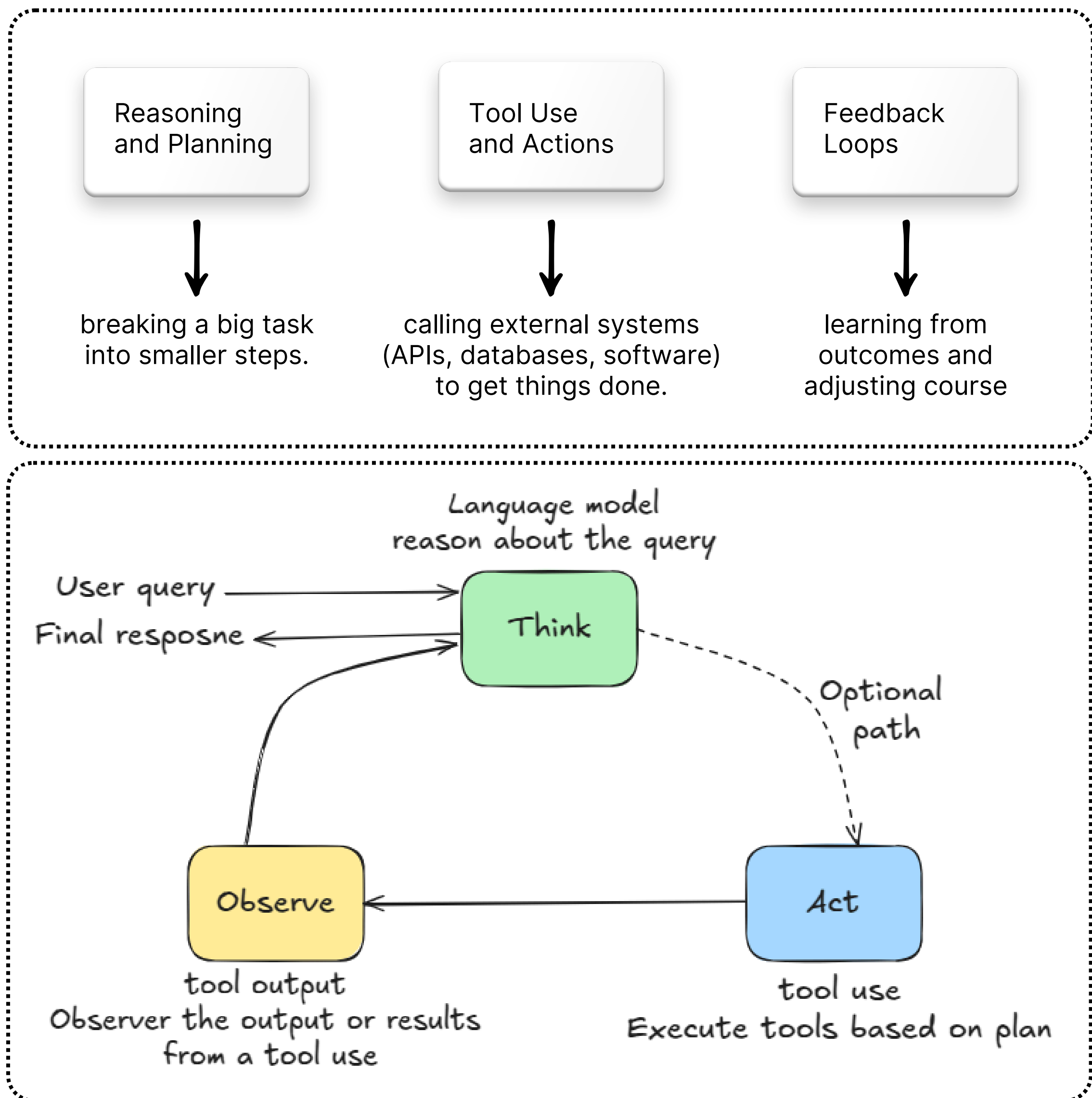


Agentic AI: A Beginner's Overview



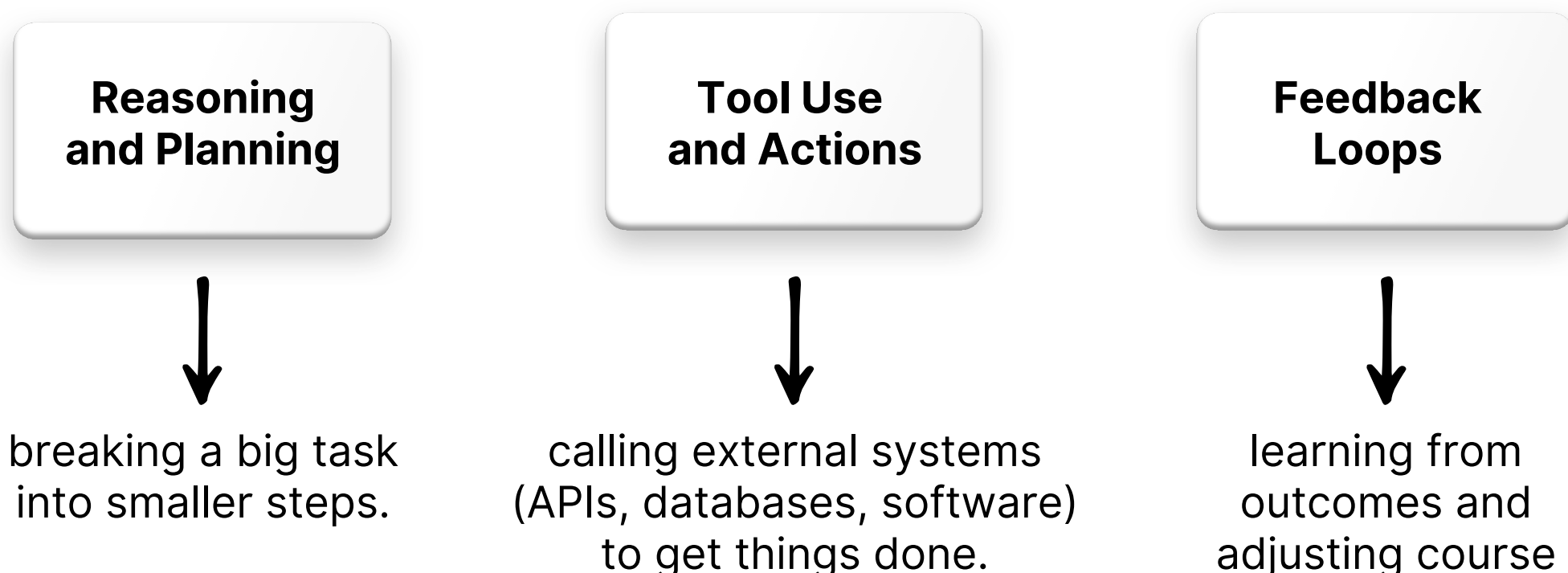
The Basics

Agentic AI is the next step beyond generative AI. Instead of simply responding to prompts or generating content, agentic AI can act with goals in mind.

It doesn't just produce outputs **it plans, takes actions, and adapts** to achieve objectives. Think of it less like a chatbot and more like an assistant that can organize your calendar, book a flight, compare options, and follow up automatically, all without needing you to prompt it at every step.

How It Works

Agentic AI combines three key abilities:



How Agentic AI Differs from Generative AI

Aspect	Generative AI	Agentic AI
Core Function	Generates text, images, code, audio based on prompts	Acts autonomously to achieve goals
Mode	Reactive – responds to user input	Proactive – initiates, plans, and executes
Scope	Single-turn outputs	Multi-step workflows
Example	Write me a poem	Plan a trip, compare flights, and book the best option
Mental Model	Pattern recognition and creation	Goal-oriented reasoning plus action

Generative AI was a leap because it gave machines the ability to create. But it still relied on humans to frame the problem and request an answer. Agentic AI shifts the dynamic: you give it a goal, not just a prompt. The system can then figure out the steps, execute them, and circle back with results. This opens up possibilities in research, business automation, personal productivity, and beyond. Instead of being just a clever tool, AI becomes a kind of digital collaborator.